Right from the very beginning the Chinese played Nehru. Just as the Chinese General Yang Chengiou read Lieutenant General Bijji Kaul like an open book, Mao understood Nehru and with well thought-out moves, made the Indian prime minister and the men around him look like a bunch of bungling amateurs.

Unlike Mao, whose rise to power was through extreme violence, having to carry the cross of non-violence after India gained independence in 1947 further hampered Nehru. He wrote in *The Discovery of India:* 'He (Gandhi) knew, of course, that there were many elements in the country, and even within the Congress, which did not have that faith in non-violence; he realised that a government of free India was likely to discard non-violence when questions of defence were concerned and build up military, naval and air power. But he wanted, if possible, for Congress at least to hold the banner of non-violence aloft, and thus to train the minds of the people and make them think increasingly in terms of peaceful action. He had a horror of seeing [India] militarised. He dreamt of India becoming a symbol and example of non-violence, and by her example weaning the rest of the world from war and the ways of violence. Even if India as a whole had not accepted this idea, Congress should not discard it when the time for trial came.'

In an interview with the *Times of India* in 1968, while discussing the Chinese invasion, Krishna Menon said: 'We did not realize that whenever China had had a powerful government she has been expansionist. Secondly, China had come into power through violence and force and nothing else; she had been at war for thirty or forty years, and the bulk of the world's people were in sympathy with the exploits of the Red Army. Thirdly, China wanted to show both us and the world that she was the largest nation.' On the other hand, Menon was to admit that during this period 'the pressure upon me from all sides was not to increase the Army efficiency and strength but to cut it down'.

Half a century after the events, most of India's popular media is obsessed with the Henderson Brooks-Bhagat Report, which remains classified even today despite the fact that there have been non-Congress governments at the centre on more than one occasion. In the immediate aftermath of 1962, it became a clever ploy for the government to deflect the blame from itself onto the army. As we know, after General Thapar's resignation, Nehru continued to play petty political games, appointing